"Your best year won't happen by accident. It's something you design. Use this workbook to bring clarity to what matters most."

2026: DESIGNED

A premium workbook to help you shape your best year yet.

BY DANIEL PINK

A MESSAGE FROM DAN:

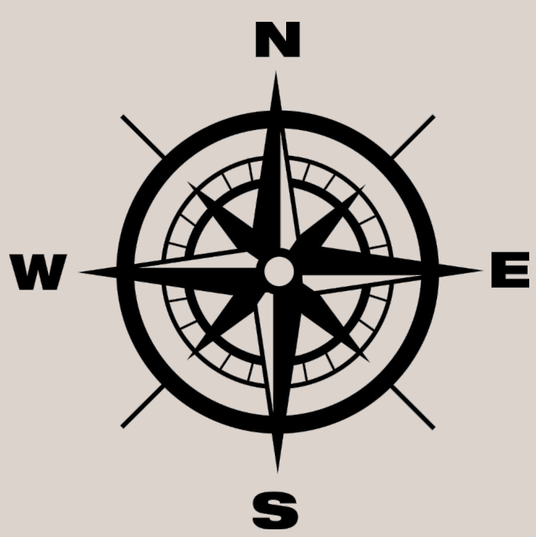
Most people enter a year with hopes. You're entering with intention. This workbook is a place to think clearly and choose deliberately so your actions match your ambitions. The pages ahead are simple, but powerful. Use them honestly. Revisit them when you drift. Let this be the year you design.

HOW THIS WORKBOOK WORKS

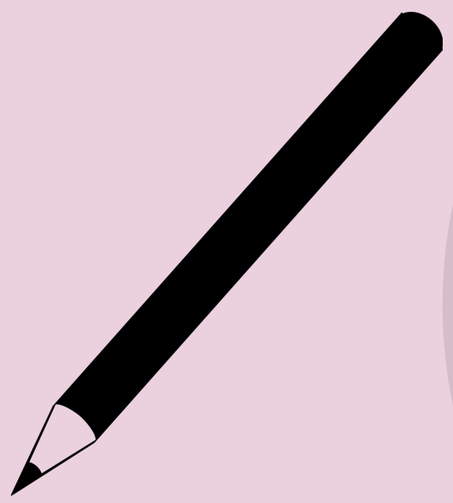
> This is not a daily planner.
> **Complete it once, then return to it periodically.**

USE IT AS:

A COMPASS



A CLARITY TOOL



A WAY TO ALIGN DECISIONS WITH WHAT MATTERS

THE BIG IDEAS FROM THE VIDEO

Strengths > weaknesses

Life is bumper cars, not chess

Choose fundamental > instrumental decisions

Passion < **Contribution**

Subtraction is a superpower

Autonomy, mastery, purpose drive

motivation

Systems create sustained progress

REGRET REVIEW

Look backward with honesty.
Look forward with intention.

My biggest regret of 2025 is:

The lesson I learned from that regret is:

The first step I'll take in the first 10 days of 2026 to act on that lessons:

PRE-MORTEM

Jump to the end of 2026. Imagine failure.
Prevent it before it happens.

My single most important project for 2026 is:

_____

_____

_____

_____

It's December 31, 2026 and this project is a complete disaster.
What went wrong?

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

How will I prevent each pitfall in the real 2026?
State the behaviors. Be specific.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

IDENTITY SNAPSHOT

A quick portrait of you at your best so you can design for it.

Three words that describe me at my best:

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

Emotions I feel when I'm at my best:

List 3 to 5

_____

_____

_____

Emotions I feel when I'm not at my best:

List 3 to 5

_____

_____

_____

Conditions that help me be at my best:

People, places, routines, environments

_____

_____

_____

STRENGTHS MAPPING

A quick portrait of you at your best so you can design for it.

Strengths I see in myself:

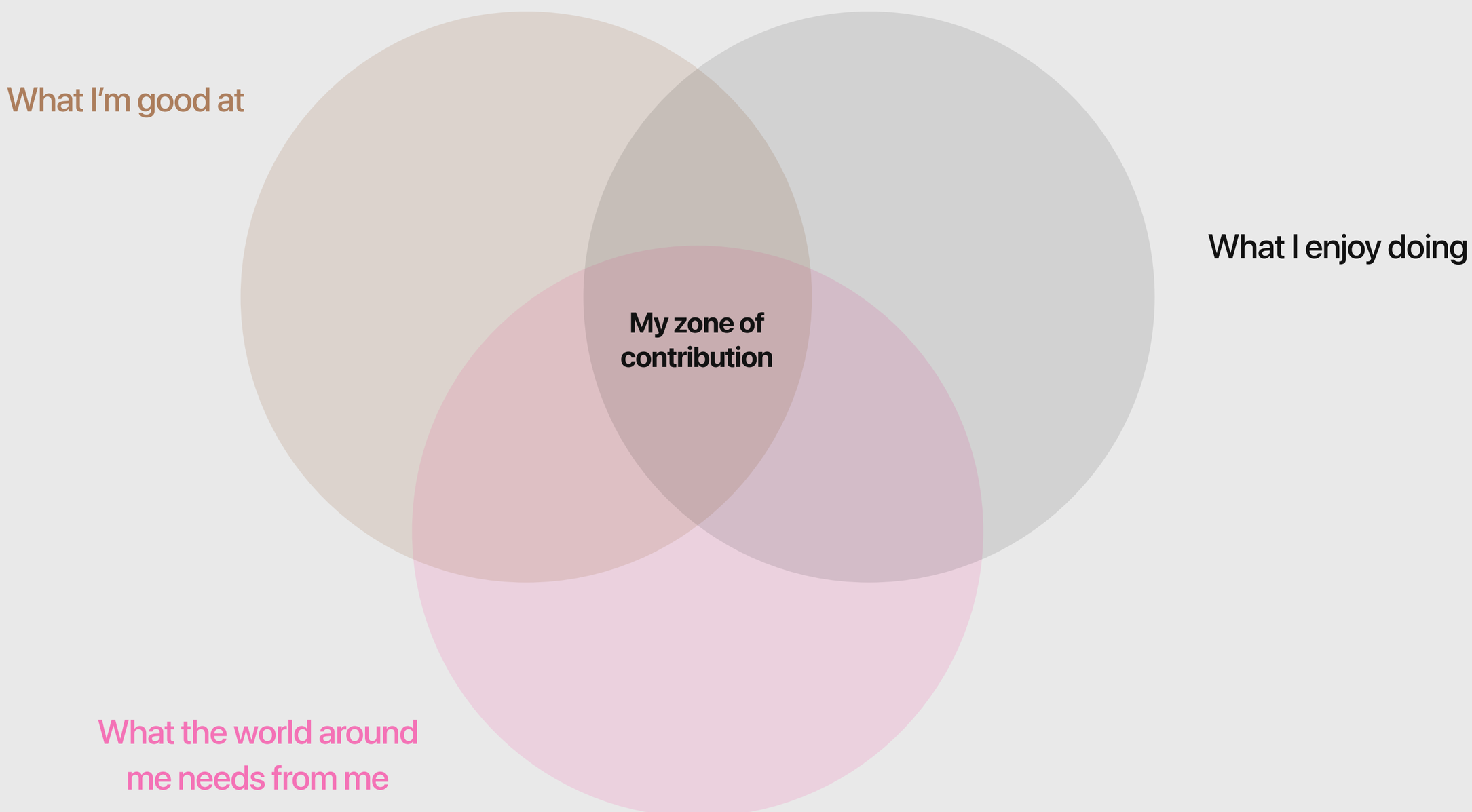
1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Strengths others see in me:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Use this space to map where your strengths meet meaning. **Be concrete.**

Return to this page whenever you feel adrift. It's a compass disguised as a list.



MY 2026 TO DON'T LIST

What you stop doing matters as much as what you start doing.

STEP 1. STOP THE TIME WASTERS

What three things consistently waste my time, divert my attention, and prevent me from doing my best work?

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

Test for each item: if I stopped doing this for 90 days, would my life get better? ***If yes, it belongs here***

STEP 2. TURN THEM INTO "TO-DON'TS."

Based on this list above, my "To Don't" List for 2026 is:

1. Don't _____

2. Don't _____

3. Don't _____

THE ENDURANCE TEST

Progress comes from choosing the discomfort you're willing to repeat.

Jerry Seinfeld once said that the secret to success is finding "the torture you're willing to endure."

What deep discomfort am I willing to endure regularly to get great at something?:
Be specific. Something you can do weekly or daily.

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

What three skills in my life have already rewarded long-term effort?

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

THE CONTRIBUTION BLUEPRINT

The architecture of why you contribute, who you help, what you do, and **the impact you aim for in 2026.**

WHY

What matters enough to deserve my energy this year?

WHO

Whose life or work gets better when I'm at my best?

WHAT

What I will contribute consistently (small, repeatable acts):

IMPACT

The single meaningful contribution I hope will define my 2026:

MY ANTI-PLAN

You can't control the year. But you can control how you move through it.
Most plans fail because they try to predict the future.

An Anti-Plan does something smarter: it separates what you can shape from what you can't and lets you focus your energy where it actually matters.

WHAT I CAN'T CONTROL

Think: other people, external events, outcomes, timing, luck.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

WHAT I CAN CONTROL

Think: actions, habits, attention, boundaries, systems.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

MY ANCHOR PRINCIPLES FOR 2026

Write 1–2 sentences describing how you'll respond when the year doesn't go as planned.

_____

_____

_____

_____

Return to this page whenever life surprises you — which it will.
The Anti-Plan keeps you steady when the plan breaks.

THE MOTIVATION SWITCHES

Flip the three switches that power sustained motivation.

AUTONOMY

"I choose to direct my life by _____."

MASTERY

"I want to regularly get better at _____."

PURPOSE

"The work that matters most to me is _____

because _____."

2026 PRIORITIES COMPASS

A one-page map for how you'll move through the year

NORTH

Long-term projects I will prioritize

These are your multi-month commitments.
The things your future self cares about.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

WEST

Daily habits I will deepen

Specific regular behaviors whose benefits compound

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

EAST

Relationships I will invest in

The people who help you flourish personally and professionally

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

SOUTH

Daily habits I will subtract

Things I seem to do every day that do not push me forward.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

THE THREE WINS OF 2026

Define success before the year begins. If these three things happen, 2026 is a success, regardless of the surprises, setbacks, or detours along the way.

Choose wins that are specific, measurable, and under your control.

MY THREE WINS:

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

WHY THESE WINS MATTER

Write 1–2 sentences explaining how each win improves your life or work. This anchors motivation.

_____

_____

_____

_____

MY 2026 CHALLENGE NETWORK

A small circle that keeps me sharp.

CHALLENGER

Pushes me. Tells me the truth.

Name: _____

Why they're right for this role: _____

_____

CHEERLEADER

Lifts me up. Helps me keep going.

Name: _____

Why they're right for this role: _____

_____

_____

COACH

A step ahead. Sees what I can't yet see.

Name: _____

Why they're right for this role: _____

_____

_____

HOW WE'LL WORK TOGETHER

Format:

- ☐ Feedback Fridays
- ☐ Email
- ☐ Call/Zoom
- ☐ In-person

Cadence (choose one):

- ☐ Weekly
- ☐ Biweekly
- ☐ Monthly

COMMITMENT

I'll invite all three by (date): _____

MY 2026 THEME

Pick one word – and only one word – as your theme for 2026.

Write it below:

Now write the word bigger, tear out this page, and post it where you'll see it throughout the year.

QUARTERLY REFLECTION

Use this page four times throughout the year.
Each section is designed to help you recalibrate with clarity and intention.

Q1 REFLECTION (JAN–MAR)

Revisit your Theme, Compass, Three Wins, and To-Don't List before you begin.

What worked: _____

_____

What didn't work / what to subtract: _____

_____

_____

What surprised me: _____

_____

_____

How well I lived my Theme: _____

_____

_____

What I'll adjust next quarter: _____

_____

_____

One action for the next 7 days: _____

_____

_____

QUARTERLY REFLECTION

Q2 REFLECTION (APR–JUN)

Revisit your Theme, Compass, Three Wins, and To-Don't List before you begin.

What worked: _____

_____

_____

What didn't work / what to subtract: _____

_____

_____

What surprised me: _____

_____

_____

How well I lived my Theme: _____

_____

_____

What I'll adjust next quarter: _____

_____

_____

One action for the next 7 days: _____

_____

_____

QUARTERLY REFLECTION

Q3 REFLECTION (JUL–SEP)

Revisit your Theme, Compass, Three Wins, and To-Don't List before you begin.

What worked: _____

_____

_____

What didn't work / what to subtract: _____

_____

_____

What surprised me: _____

_____

_____

How well I lived my Theme: _____

_____

_____

What I'll adjust next quarter: _____

_____

_____

One action for the next 7 days: _____

_____

_____

QUARTERLY REFLECTION

Q4 REFLECTION (OCT–DEC)

Revisit your Theme, Compass, Three Wins, and To-Don't List before you begin.

What worked: _____

_____

_____

What didn't work / what to subtract: _____

_____

_____

What surprised me: _____

_____

_____

How well I lived my Theme: _____

_____

_____

What I'll adjust next quarter: _____

_____

_____

One action for the next 7 days: _____

_____

_____

Design a year that feels like you. Not a year that impresses others.

When you drift, **return here.**

When you lose clarity, **return here.**

When you need direction, **return here.**

NOTES